

- ↔ 8–10 in (20–25 cm)
- ⚖ 7–17 oz (200–475 g)
- ⊗ Common
- 🌲 Conifer seeds, nuts



W. Europe to W. Asia

▷ **TUFTED EARS**

Unlike gray squirrels, red squirrels have tufts on their ears, which are particularly long in winter.



fluffy tail,
molts
annually

Eurasian red squirrel

Sciurus vulgaris

Eurasian red squirrels have remarkably varied coat colors, with the upper coats ranging from very light red to black. However, only the red form occurs in the UK. Agile climbers, these rodents can leap distances of up to 13 ft (4m) and have great vision, hearing, and sense of smell.

Focus on food

Red squirrels spend most of the day feeding or caching food, such as seeds and nuts. In the warmest hours of summer, they retire to a drey, or nest. They do not hibernate, relying on their food stores to survive winter, but they stay in their drey in harsh weather. Males compete for females, but play no role in caring for young, and, aside from mating, these rodents live mainly independent lives.

Although found across most of Europe, they are restricted to a few mixed woodlands in areas where they have to compete with the larger, more successful gray squirrel introduced from North America.



△ **EYES OPEN**

Squirrel kits spend their first weeks in a drey, lined with soft moss and grass, opening their eyes at around five weeks old.